Venkatesh Gardas

Product Manager · Fintech · B2B SaaS · AI Products

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SUMMARY

Product manager with 6+ years across fintech, B2B SaaS and GenAI products, owning the full product lifecycle from discovery to launch. As Product Owner on a procure-to-pay platform, I owned the roadmap, led a cross-functional team of 7 and delivered for enterprise clients including HDFC, HDB, Akasa Air, Bajaj Allianz and Utkarsh Bank. Most recently owned the product side of an AI risk analytics platform at Technet LLC, reaching 90% adoption. I also design and ship my own AI products end to end. Known for turning messy customer problems into configurable products that scale across clients.

SKILLS

- **Product:** Product strategy, end-to-end product lifecycle, discovery, requirements gathering, user research, competitive analysis, roadmap and prioritization (RICE), MVP definition, PRDs, user stories and acceptance criteria, go-to-market and adoption.
- **Delivery & Leadership:** Agile/Scrum, sprint planning, backlog management, release planning, UAT, stakeholder management, cross-functional collaboration (engineering, design, QA, sales), client implementations.
- **AI:** GenAI and LLM product design, prompt design, human-in-the-loop and exception logic, AI evaluation and trade-offs (latency, accuracy, cost).
- **Data & Tools:** Product analytics, KPIs and OKRs, data-driven decision making, SQL, Power BI, cohort and retention analysis, A/B testing, Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, Figma, Lucidchart, Claude, Cursor.
- **Domain:** Fintech, B2B SaaS, procure-to-pay (P2P), budgeting and spend control, AP automation, loan origination, ERP and REST API integrations, risk analytics, e-commerce.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Manager, Technet LLC *Aug 2025 – Aug 2026 · USA*

- Owned the product side of an AI-driven risk analytics platform for finance and risk teams: gathered requirements from business users and turned them into specs for the data science and technology teams.
- Defined, across **40+ automated decision flows**, when the model acts on its own and when it escalates to a human, including inputs, outputs and scoring thresholds.
- Drove adoption with a skeptical user base through workshops, phased rollouts and visible model reasoning, reaching **90% adoption** with **95% of milestones** on time.
- Shipped Power BI and SQL dashboards that cut reporting time **22%**, improved accuracy **28%** and reduced decision cycle time **16%**.

Product Owner, Expenzing *Apr 2022 – Jul 2024 · Mumbai, India*

- Owned the roadmap and backlog for a B2B procure-to-pay SaaS platform (requisitions, approvals, purchase orders, invoices, vendors), leading a team of **7** (developers, QA, business analyst) through sprint-based releases.
- Turned one client's overspend problem into a configurable **Budgeting module** (department and cost-center budgets, block-or-flag rules at requisition, live spend tracking) that became a **standard paid feature** for all clients.
- Designed reconciliation logic after finding credit notes and pending invoices were silently pushing budgets negative: credit notes now offset automatically and pending invoices reserve budget before approval.
- Shipped OCR invoice capture on mobile after research showed users submitting invoices were rarely at a desk, contributing to a **40%** improvement in transaction speed.
- Designed a Loan Origination module for HDB bringing credit approval and disbursement tracking into the platform, which became a paid module and lifted deal size.

- Owned implementations end to end for HDFC, HDB, Akasa Air, CoinDCX, Bajaj Allianz and Utkarsh Bank: requirement workshops, ERP API integrations, UAT, training, go-live and support. Scoped and estimated change requests to protect timelines and revenue.

Data Modeler, Purplle *Jan 2021 – Jan 2022 · Mumbai, India*

- Built the SQL pipelines, cohort dashboards and retention models the product team used to make decisions, contributing to a **12% drop in churn** and **15% growth in repeat orders**.
- Worked with product and marketing to define what to measure, and supported A/B tests by helping decide what was worth testing.

Business Analyst, Globe Trek Engineering *Jan 2020 – Jan 2021 · Mumbai, India*

- Gathered requirements from operations, procurement and finance users for ERP and logistics modules, and wrote the user stories and acceptance criteria engineering built from.
- Set up the testing and UAT process and tracked issues to closure, cutting delivery risk by **25%**.

PRODUCTS BUILT (END TO END, USING AI TOOLS)

Saathi – *AI voice companion for elderly Indians (live, heysaathi.vercel.app):* One button, the user speaks and Saathi replies out loud in Malayalam, Telugu, Hindi or English, remembering them across days, with a family dashboard. Cut time to first voice from 1,032 ms to **about 250 ms** by streaming replies, held the interface to WCAG 2.1 AAA contrast, and designed a relationship model so the AI never gets too personal too fast. Built on Claude and Sarvam AI.

PitStop – *Garage management platform (live, in daily use by a real workshop):* Covers intake, job cards, mechanic assignment, customer estimate approval, GST invoicing, payments, inventory, purchase orders and supplier tracking, plus an AI feature that reads photographed repair bills into structured service history.

AWARDS

Driving Customer Communication Award (best customer handling), Expenzing

Product Development Award, Expenzing

Recognised for successful implementations at Bajaj Allianz, Akasa Air and Utkarsh Bank

EDUCATION

M.S. Applied Information Technology, George Mason University, Virginia, USA *2024 – 2026*

MBA, IBS Mumbai *2020 – 2022*

B.S. Information Technology, Bhavna Trust College, Mumbai *2016 – 2019*

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) · Certified Scrum Master (CSM) · PMP (in progress)

Microsoft Certified: Power Platform Solution Architect Expert · Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)